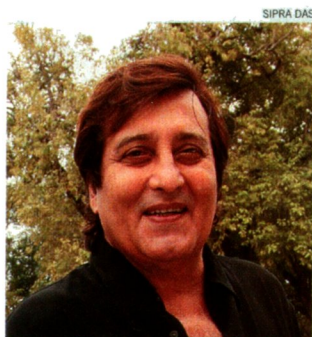




India's Best & Worst States PUNJAB KERALA HIMACHAL PRADESH TAMIL NADU HARYANA UTTARAKHAND MAHARASHTRA



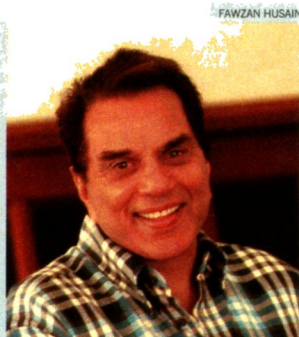
SIPRA DAS

VINOD KHANNA
BJP
GURDASPUR, PUNJAB
RANK

Socio-economic Infrastructure

105 | 100

Being located in a prosperous state has its own advantages but will the cine star be able to make it to the top 100?



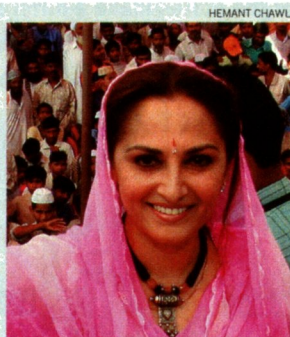
FAWZAN HUSAIN

DHARMENDRA
BJP
BIKANER, RAJASTHAN
RANK

Socio-economic Infrastructure

431 | 261

Bikaner obviously needs political muscle which the he-man must flex for change and development.



HEMANT CHAWLA

P. JAYA PRADA NAHATA
SAMAJWADI PARTY
RAMPUR, UTTAR PRADESH
RANK

Socio-economic Infrastructure

437 | 321

First time MP, but being a member of the party in power didn't help the people of her constituency much.



SIPRA DAS

GOVIND AHUJA
CONGRESS
MUMBAI NORTH, MAHARASHTRA
RANK

Socio-economic Infrastructure

3 | 8

Giant killer of the last Lok Sabha elections and Hero No. 1, but ranking is largely due to its location.

LATUR elected Home Minister Shivraj Patil seven times, but is ranked 220.

SURAT, which elected Morarji Desai, is the only prime ministerial constituency in the top 100.

what appears like a rule then it is Baramati represented by Union Minister for Agriculture, Food and Consumer Affairs Sharad Pawar five times. Using a combination of native ingenuity, power and clout with corporate, Pawar has transformed the drought-ridden region into a model constituency that ranks 51 for infrastructure access and 107 on socio-economic measures.

Clearly there is something rotten in the state of governance. Although a republic since 1950, India really has been practicing a form of benign monarchy where the God-fearing voters elected their MPs on faith hoping for the best. Rajiv Gandhi once described Indian democracy very succinctly. He said, "*lokshahi* is 99 per cent *sunwayi* (democratic politics is predominantly a willingness to give a patient hearing)". All that is changing now. Voters want the representatives to deliver on public goods and private aspirations. So MPs, even though they are elected to legislate laws at the Central level, are expected to monitor everything from bad sanitation in the neighbourhood to public transport in the constituency. The landscape is littered with

instances of poor governance—from teacher-less schools to water-less pipes to a crumbling public delivery system for foodgrains. And there is no shortage of prescriptions for these are issues that have haunted India for decades. It is at this level that MPs need to intervene but clearly there is little sign of this.

At the assembly level, anti-incumbency is as high as 65 per cent while it is between 45 and 55 per cent at the parliamentary level. Indian politicians have diagnosed the problem but have got the cure wrong. Ironically, parties believe dropping sitting MPs is the best way to beat incumbency and return to power. Typically that is the worst case of mal-prescription. Unless public representatives realise that the huge monster called government is made to deliver, they will be haunted by anti-incumbency and their voters by poor governance. These ratings simply reflect the distance between the need of the voting class and a slothful system. ■

For more on the survey, log on to

<http://www.indiatoday.com>

